SkillUp

Lab: Generating BRDs, FRDs, SRS, User Manuals, and Stakeholder Interview Simulation

Estimated time: 40 minutes

Learning objectives:

After completing this lab, you will be able to:

- Generate structured requirement documents, including BRDs, FRDs, and SRS, using AI prompts
- Create user-facing documentation from technical requirements
- Use traceability matrices to ensure alignment across all project deliverables

Introduction

This lab teaches you to transform stakeholder interview transcripts into professional requirement documents using AI. You will generate a **Business Requirements Document (BRD)**, **Functional Requirements Document (FRD)**, **Software Requirements Specification (SRS)**, and **User Manual**. You will then create a **traceability matrix** to ensure that all documents are aligned and consistent.

These documents are essential for software projects, helping teams understand what to build, how it should function, and how users will interact with the system. The traceability matrix ensures that business goals connect to features, features connect to technical specs, and everything aligns with user documentation.

Required tools

- Web AI tool (ChatGPT or Claude)
- Interview transcript from previous lab activity

Exercise 1: Generate requirements documents and User Manual

In this exercise, you will use your interview transcript to generate four essential project documents: **BRD**, **FRD**, **SRS**, and **User Manual**. Each document serves a specific purpose and audience, building upon the previous document to create a complete documentation set.

Step 1: Generate the Business Requirements Document (BRD)

1. Open your AI tool and provide your interview transcript from the previous lab
2. Prompt the AI to create a BRD that includes: executive summary, business goals, project scope, key stakeholders, high-level requirements, and success criteria
3. Review the generated BRD and verify that it captures the business perspective from your interview

Hint

Example prompt:

```
"Using this interview transcript, create a Business Requirements Document (BRD) with the following sections: Executive Summary, Business Goals and Objectives, Project Scope, Key Stakeholders, High-Level Requirements, Success Criteria and Metrics, Timeline and Budget Considerations, and Risks and Constraints."
```

Step 2: Generate the Functional Requirements Document (FRD)

1. Prompt the AI to create an FRD using your interview transcript and the BRD as reference
2. Ensure the FRD includes: functional features, user stories, use cases, and system workflows
3. Review the FRD to confirm all features mentioned in the interview are documented

Hint

Example prompt:

```
"Using the interview transcript and BRD, create a Functional Requirements Document (FRD) with these sections: Functional Overview, Detailed Feature List, User Stories for each feature, Use Cases with step-by-step workflows, User Interface Requirements, and Data Requirements. Make sure each requirement references back to business goals in the BRD."
```

Step 3: Generate the Software Requirements Specification (SRS)

1. Prompt the AI to create an SRS using your interview transcript, BRD, and FRD as inputs
2. Ensure the SRS includes: detailed technical requirements, system architecture, acceptance criteria, and traceability links to the BRD and FRD
3. Review the SRS to verify that technical details support the functional requirements

Hint

Example prompt:

```
"Using the interview transcript, BRD, and FRD, create a Software Requirements Specification (SRS) with: System Overview, Technical Architecture, Detailed Technical Requirements for each feature, Performance Requirements, Security Requirements, Acceptance Criteria for each requirement, and a Traceability section linking SRS requirements to FRD features and BRD business goals."
```

Step 4: Generate the User Manual

1. Prompt the AI to create a User Manual based on your FRD and SRS.
2. Ensure the User Manual includes: getting started guide, feature explanations, step-by-step instructions, troubleshooting, and FAQs.
3. Review the User Manual to confirm it uses simple, user-friendly language (not technical jargon).

Hint

Example prompt:

```
"Using the FRD and SRS, create a User Manual with: Getting Started section, Overview of Key Features, Step-by-Step Instructions for each major feature (with screenshots descriptions), Troubleshooting Common Issues, and Frequently Asked Questions. Write in clear, simple language for end users without technical backgrounds. Focus on what users can do, not how the system works technically."
```

Exercise 2: Create a traceability matrix to align documents

In this exercise, you will create a **traceability matrix** to ensure that all your documents are aligned. A traceability matrix shows how business requirements connect to functional requirements, which connect to technical specifications, ensuring nothing is missed and everything supports the business goals.

Step 1: Generate the traceability matrix

1. Prompt the AI to create a traceability matrix linking requirements across all four documents
2. The matrix should show how each business requirement (BRD) maps to functional requirements (FRD), technical specifications (SRS), and user documentation (User Manual)
3. Review the matrix to identify any gaps or misalignments

Step 2: Review and refine document alignment

1. Use the traceability matrix to check for:
   - Business requirements that don't have corresponding functional requirements
   - Functional requirements without technical specifications
   - Features in the User Manual that aren't traced back to requirements
2. If you find gaps, prompt the AI to add missing requirements or links between documents.

Hint

Example prompt:

```
"Create a traceability matrix in table format with columns for: BRD ID, Business Requirement, FRD ID, Functional Requirement, SRS ID, Technical Specification, and User Manual Section. Show how each business goal traces through to user documentation."
```

Sample traceability matrix

BRD ID	Business Requirement	FRD ID	Functional Requirement	SRS ID	User Manual Section
BR-001	Users must be able to log in securely	FR-001	System provides username/password authentication	SRS-001	Section 2.1: Logging In
BR-002	System must process payments quickly	FR-005	Payment processing within 3 seconds	SRS-012	Section 4.3: Making Payments

Summary

In this lab, you practiced using AI to generate professional requirement documents from interview transcripts. You created four essential documents—**BRD**, **FRD**, **SRS**, and **User Manual**—each serving a specific purpose in the software development process. You then used a **traceability matrix** to ensure that all documents are aligned and consistent, verifying that business goals connect to features, features connect to technical specifications, and everything is documented for users.

These skills are fundamental for business analysts and anyone involved in software project planning, helping ensure projects are well-documented from business strategy through to user adoption.